

Value the Time

Vocabulary, Grammar, and Comprehension Handout
Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

(Corrections are shown in bold.)

I'm curious about your perspective on **valuing time**. I've started to explore the truth about this issue after I **heard** a thoughtful experience from my best friend Jola this morning. "Do you know why poverty **and** wealth exist **in** the world? It's not **as** unfair as those people **say**; the truth is....." **The** question from Jola ignited my passion **and** prompted me to make up my mind to embark on the journey.....

Memories of a Sincere Friendship

I was awakened by the warm dawn light streaming in from outside. I suddenly remembered **my** appointment with Jola. When I stepped into the cafe, the aroma of coffee **was** attractive. Surprisingly, Jola had already arrived and greeted me warmly. **I responded** with a friendly smile. **As** I noticed **she had** changed, she said with a grateful **heart**, "I'm so glad that I've changed a lot." Jola shared her opinions happily. "Since I met you, I **have** finally understood that our life is not a challenge to escape; learning is not for the exam; practicing is not for competitions....."

Before, I studied all day to make **a** good impression on **the** adults. **However**, since I started **getting** the **praise** that I **had** always longed for, I noticed that I'd lost my friendships—even the true hope and dream **that** I **had** once **wished** upon **a** star **had** disappeared.

To maintain good grades, I **couldn't** spend time with my loved **ones**, **or** even with myself. I **couldn't** find the inner peace to balance **the** overwhelming **feelings** and fear."

Reminder: Cherish Your Life, Time, and Memories

Life is a long path **of** growth. **We study** for ourselves, not for our teachers, parents, or **supporters**. **Although** life is **surrounded** by danger, **uncertainty**, and endless **failures** and hurdles **that** we have to face **and** overcome, **it is** still filled with love, **hope**, and the **drive** to thrive.....

Life is short, and so is time. **Do** the **things** that you really want to do, **spend time** with the **people you** really care about, **and** enjoy **every** moment that **makes** you smile. Cherish your life, time, and memories. **You're** worthy **of** embarking on the road that is only for you. Remember, you're more capable **than** you think!

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

I've always been curious about how people think about time and its value. This curiosity deepened after a meaningful conversation with my best friend, Jola, one morning. She posed a thought-provoking question: "Do you know why poverty and wealth exist in this world? It's not as unfair as people claim; the truth is....." That single question ignited something inside me—a burning desire to reflect more deeply on life—and prompted me to embark on a journey of self-discovery.

Memories of a Sincere Friendship

That morning, I was gently awakened by the warm golden light of dawn streaming through my window. I suddenly remembered that I had an appointment with Jola. When I arrived at the café, the rich aroma of freshly brewed coffee welcomed me. To my surprise, Jola was already there, waiting with a warm smile. I greeted her cheerfully, and as I sat down, I couldn't help but notice how much she had changed. There was a quiet confidence about her that hadn't been there before.

With a grateful heart, she said, "I'm so glad I've changed." Then she began to share her thoughts openly. "Ever since I met you, I've come to understand something important: life is not a challenge to escape from. Learning is not just about passing exams, and practice is not just about winning competitions....."

I used to spend entire days studying, all for the sake of making a good impression on the adults around me. But here's what I didn't realize: once I finally started receiving the praise I had always longed for, I looked around and discovered that I had lost something far more valuable—my friendships, my sense of joy, and even the dreams I had once wished upon a star had quietly disappeared.

In my pursuit of good grades, I couldn't make time for my loved ones, or even for myself. I was unable to find inner peace, constantly overwhelmed by pressure and fear."

A Reminder: Cherish Your Life, Time, and Memories

Life is a long and winding path of growth. Ultimately, we study for ourselves—not for our teachers, our parents, or anyone else. Although life is surrounded by danger, uncertainty, and countless hurdles that we must face and overcome, it remains rich with love, hope, and the incredible drive to thrive.

Life is short, and time is precious. So do the things that truly matter to you. Accompany the people who fill your heart with joy, and savor every moment that brings a smile to your face. Cherish your life, your time, and the memories you create along the way. You are worthy of embarking on a path that is entirely your own. And always remember—you are far more capable than you think!

PART A: VOCABULARY (18 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	ignite (v.)	to inspire or trigger a strong feeling or action. "That single question ignited something inside me."
2	embark (v.)	to begin a journey or a new course of action. "Prompted me to embark on a journey of self-discovery."
3	sincere (adj.)	genuine, honest, and free from pretense. "Memories of a sincere friendship."
4	dawn (n.)	the early morning; the beginning of something new. "The warm golden light of dawn streaming through my window."
5	aroma (n.)	a pleasant, distinctive smell. "The rich aroma of freshly brewed coffee welcomed me."
6	grateful (adj.)	feeling thankful and appreciative. "With a grateful heart, she said..."
7	escape (v.)	to break free from something unpleasant or restrictive. "Life is not a challenge to escape from."
8	impression (n.)	an opinion or feeling formed about someone or something. "All for the sake of making a good impression."
9	longed for (phr. v.)	to have a strong desire or wish for something. "The praise I had always longed for."
10	disappear (v.)	to cease to be visible or to exist. "My dreams had quietly disappeared."
11	inner (adj.)	relating to the mind, spirit, or emotions. "I was unable to find inner peace."
12	overwhelm (v.)	to have a strong emotional effect; to overpower. "Constantly overwhelmed by pressure and fear."
13	uncertainty (n.)	the state of being unsure or not knowing. "Life is surrounded by danger, uncertainty, and countless hurdles."
14	hurdle (n.)	an obstacle or difficulty that must be overcome. "Countless hurdles that we must face and overcome."
15	thrive (v.)	to grow, develop, or prosper. "It remains rich with love, hope, and the incredible drive to thrive."
16	accompany (v.)	to go together with; to spend time with someone. "Accompany the people who fill your heart with joy."
17	capable (adj.)	having the ability or qualities to do something. "You are far more capable than you think."
18	worthy (adj.)	deserving of respect, attention, or effort. "You are worthy of embarking on a path that is entirely your own."

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. The sunset over the ocean was a _____ sight that left everyone speechless.
a) sincere b) grateful c) worthy d) capable
2. A single conversation with her _____ his desire to become a writer.
a) escaped b) overwhelmed c) ignited d) accompanied
3. After graduating, she decided to _____ on a career in medicine.
a) embark b) thrive c) disappear d) escape
4. The _____ of freshly baked bread drew customers into the bakery.
a) dawn b) impression c) hurdle d) aroma
5. He was deeply _____ for the support his family gave him during hard times.
a) inner b) sincere c) grateful d) capable
6. Many animals _____ in their natural habitats but struggle in captivity.
a) accompany b) thrive c) overwhelm d) ignite
7. Learning a new language is a _____ that takes time and patience to overcome.
a) dawn b) hurdle c) impression d) uncertainty
8. She had _____ a normal life free from stress for many years.
a) accompanied b) overwhelmed c) longed for d) escaped
9. The magician made the coin _____ right before our eyes.
a) thrive b) embark c) disappear d) accompany
10. You are _____ of achieving great things if you believe in yourself.
a) worthy b) inner c) overwhelming d) capable

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

sincere dawn impression escape uncertainty

1. She gave a _____ apology that showed she truly meant every word.
2. At _____, the birds began to sing and the sky turned orange and pink.
3. He tried to _____ from the boring meeting by pretending he had a phone call.
4. First _____ matter a lot in job interviews, so dress professionally.
5. The _____ about the future made her feel anxious and restless.

inner overwhelm worthy accompany hurdle

6. Finding _____ peace requires time, patience, and self-reflection.
7. The amount of homework can sometimes _____ students, causing stress.
8. Every person is _____ of being treated with kindness and respect.
9. Would you like me to _____ you to the doctor's appointment?
10. The biggest _____ for the team was the lack of funding for the project.

PART B: GRAMMAR (5 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: “Used to + verb” for past habits

Form: Subject + used to + base verb

Use: To describe habits or states that were true in the past but are no longer true.

Example from text: *“I used to study all day just to make a good impression.”*

More examples:

- She used to live in Tokyo before moving to London.
- We used to walk to school every day when we were children.
- He used to be shy, but now he’s very outgoing.

Pattern 2: “Although + clause” for concession

Form: Although + subject + verb..., subject + verb...

Use: To acknowledge one fact while presenting a contrasting or surprising result.

Example from text: *“Although life is surrounded by danger, uncertainty, and failures, it is still filled with love and hope.”*

More examples:

- Although it was raining heavily, they continued the outdoor event.
- Although she was tired, she stayed up to finish the project.
- Although he failed the first time, he never gave up.

Pattern 3: Passive voice with “be + surrounded by”

Form: Subject + be + past participle + by + agent/noun

Use: To describe a state where the subject is affected by something around it.

Example from text: *“Life is surrounded by danger, uncertainty, and endless failures.”*

More examples:

- The village is surrounded by mountains on all sides.
- She was impressed by his dedication and hard work.
- The city was damaged by the earthquake last year.

Pattern 4: “Be + worthy of + gerund/noun”

Form: Subject + be + worthy of + gerund/noun

Use: To express that someone or something deserves a particular action or quality.

Example from text: *“You are worthy of embarking on a road that is yours alone.”*

More examples:

- This book is worthy of reading more than once.
- She is worthy of the award for her outstanding performance.
- The museum is worthy of a visit if you’re in the area.

Pattern 5: “Once + clause” for turning points

Form: Once + subject + verb (past)..., subject + verb (past)...

Use: To show that after a certain event happened, something else followed as a result.

Example from text: *“Once I started getting the praise I had always longed for, I realized that I had lost my friendships.”*

More examples:

- Once she understood the problem, she found the solution quickly.
- Once they moved to the countryside, their quality of life improved.
- Once you try this dish, you'll never want to eat anywhere else.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. He _____ play basketball every weekend, but now he prefers swimming.
a) use to b) used to c) is used to d) uses to
2. _____ the test was difficult, most of the students passed.
a) Although b) Because c) So d) Unless
3. The castle is _____ by a beautiful garden.
a) surrounding b) surround c) surrounded d) surrounds
4. This charity is _____ of receiving more public support.
a) worth b) worthy c) worthwhile d) worthless
5. _____ he learned the truth, he couldn't trust her anymore.
a) Although b) Unless c) Once d) While
6. She _____ be very quiet in class, but now she participates actively.
a) is used to b) would used to c) used to d) uses to
7. _____ she had no experience, she still got the job.
a) Once b) Because c) Although d) Unless
8. The small island is _____ by crystal-clear water.
a) surrounding b) surrounded c) surrounds d) surround
9. Everyone is _____ of being loved and respected.
a) worth b) worthwhile c) worthy d) worthless
10. _____ the rain stopped, the children ran outside to play.
a) Although b) Unless c) Because d) Once

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

Used to + verb

1. When I was young, I walked to school every day. (used to)

2. She ate meat before, but now she is a vegetarian. (used to)

Although

3. The movie was long. It was very entertaining. (Although...)

4. He doesn't earn a lot of money. He is always generous. (Although...)

Passive voice with "surrounded by"

5. Tall trees are on all sides of the lake. (The lake is...)

6. Loving family members are always around her. (She is...)

Worthy of

7. This film deserves to win an award. (This film is worthy of...)

8. He deserves a second chance. (He is worthy of...)

Once + clause

9. She tasted the cake. Then she wanted the recipe immediately. (Once...)

10. He started exercising regularly. His health improved dramatically. (Once...)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. c) worthy 2. c) ignited 3. a) embark 4. d) aroma 5. c) grateful
6. b) thrive 7. b) hurdle 8. c) longed for 9. c) disappear 10. d) capable

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. sincere 2. dawn 3. escape 4. impression 5. uncertainty
6. inner 7. overwhelm 8. worthy 9. accompany 10. hurdle

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) used to 2. a) Although 3. c) surrounded 4. b) worthy 5. c) Once
6. c) used to 7. c) Although 8. b) surrounded 9. c) worthy 10. d) Once

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. I used to walk to school every day when I was young.
2. She used to eat meat, but now she is a vegetarian.
3. Although the movie was long, it was very entertaining.
4. Although he doesn't earn a lot of money, he is always generous.
5. The lake is surrounded by tall trees on all sides.
6. She is surrounded by loving family members.
7. This film is worthy of winning an award.
8. He is worthy of a second chance.
9. Once she tasted the cake, she wanted the recipe immediately.
10. Once he started exercising regularly, his health improved dramatically.

Comprehension Questions (Sample Answers)

1. Jola is the author's best friend. She asked, "Do you know why poverty and wealth exist in the world?"
2. The author met Jola at a café. By the time the author arrived, Jola had already arrived and was waiting.
3. Jola realized that life is not a challenge to escape from, learning is not just for exams, and practicing is not just for competitions.
4. Jola studied all day to make a good impression on the adults around her. Her real motivation was to gain praise and approval from others, not for her own personal growth.
5. While chasing praise and good grades, Jola lost her friendships, her sense of inner peace, and the hopes and dreams she once had.
6. "A road that is yours alone" means a unique life path that reflects your own values, goals, and choices—rather than a path determined by others' expectations.
7. Answers will vary based on personal opinion.
8. This suggests that focusing too much on academic achievement can come at the cost of mental health and personal relationships. Success that leads to burnout and isolation may not be true success.
9. Answers will vary based on personal experience.
10. Answers will vary based on personal experience.